



Social algorithms evaluated

India is set to finally evaluate social media algorithms with the Digital India Act. <https://digit.in/dec22-11>



Apple's car in 2026?

Rumours about the Apple car indicate it'll launch in 2026. The car will run on Apple Silicon chip. <https://digit.in/dec22-12>

experience, making it more immersive than ever.

d At what stage of development is your foodverse at?

Supreet Raju: We have already launched our gaming layer. It's already live, so you can actually go right now and make your NFTs. We haven't spoken much about our virtual restaurant layer because we don't want to confuse our community. But we've partnered with a lot of people. OneRare has collaborated with celebrity chefs like Arnold Poernomo from Indonesia, Indian chef Saransh Goila, Dutch chef Jamie Van Heije and restaurateur Zorawar Kolra, who owns Massive Restaurants and Farzi Cafe.

d How do you convince these chefs and businesses to get onboard with your vision of the foodverse? I am assuming not everyone will be familiar with Web 3 and the metaverse.

Supreet Raju: What happens with chefs is that there are two kinds. Any food brand, either they know nothing or they know a lot to the point where they have themselves invested in a project. Even the ones who know nothing, they've heard in the news the word NFT, but they don't, of course, understand the technology. That's where we come in because for any chef, the idea of launching his NFTs has two problems. One, how do you do it? Where is the tech to do it? Second, why would someone want the NFT?

It's a very important question that was not answered in the previous year. 2021 was the year when people were launching NFTs just for the heck of it. Taco Bell did it. Pizza Hut did it. But 2022 needs utility in NFTs. So what we do with the chefs is that we set up a meeting and we take them through the process of how this works. So we generally collaborate on two specific points. The first is our gaming layer, so we launch their best dishes in our game.

For the second layer, the virtual restaurant, we brought them through the process of what it is that they are

seeking out of it. For example, for chef Vicky Ratnani, we are working to launch a state-of-the-art hyperreal restaurant and kitchen in the metaverse. The idea, like I said, with each of our partners is to simplify blockchain because blockchain is just a technology. We don't go asking what Instagram builds on. None of us ever ask even what Zoom is built on. We just use the app because it's convenient for us, it's productive for us. So we want our foodverse to be that layer in the food and beverage industry.

d Like most Web 3 founders, you left India for Dubai. What were the challenges of running a Web 3 business in India?

Supreet Raju: I think the most challenging thing, not just for us, but for many companies, was the lack of regulations. To be honest, we waited

a technology oriented business. So I think that is something that not just us, everybody is currently seeking.

d What are the advantages that Dubai offers?

Supreet Raju: So right now, Dubai, as a government, is really embracing blockchain technology. They held the Dubai Metaverse Assembly recently, which is a private event of 400 people organized by the Crown Prince. So he's hosting us. We are speaking on panels there to talk about what we are building and how the government can help us. So they are currently very much into it. They are setting up regulations extremely fast for how companies can accept fundraisers. Frankly, that was the prime reason for us to move. We needed a place where regulations would be more clear.



a lot for the regulations because we believe in being an India-first project. We're very proud that an Indian project is the world's first food metaverse and we got global recognition for it. And for us, it is a very big deal. But in our case, because we are fundraising on our token, there have been no regulations for us on how to accept it. So we moved because we felt that our business would stagnate if we sound stuck to our investors.

I think what we need from the government, it's just a bit more understanding of the space of the industry and moving beyond the fact that it's crypto, more into allowing people to have the framework to structure it as

d You say that nobody can predict what the metaverse will look like in a decade's time. If I may play devil, where do you think your business will be in the next ten years?

Supreet Raju: For us, we want to be an enabler where people should not be mystified with blockchain technology. It's on us to provide tools that make it easy and simple for any brand to grow on it. The exact model of how they will grow that I can't predict. I don't know what tools we will be providing them because tech is in the process of building. The idea is to just be that enabler where anybody in the global food and beverage industry is on the metaverse. **d**